

Pregnancy

Pregnancy happens as a result of unprotected sex. This might be planned, or it might be unintentional. For anyone, teen or adult, who finds out about a pregnancy, support is really important.

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Pregnancy choices

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When you can and can't get pregnant

Not every sexual encounter results in pregnancy, but it only takes one successful sperm to fertilize an egg, so it's best to be aware of how exactly a person can and can't get pregnant.

You can get pregnant:

- even if it's your first time (it's a myth that you can't).
- if it's during your period (sperm can live for five days inside the uterus until the fertile window begins).
- if the man pulls out before ejaculation (the penis can secrete a fluid before ejaculation that contains sperm).
- if contraception is used incorrectly or fails (no method of contraception is 100 percent effective).

You can't get pregnant:

- through masturbation, oral sex, or anal sex (however, pregnancy can occur if semen is ejaculated outside the female's body and then reaches the vagina).
- if you're not having sex.

Finding out you're pregnant

The most obvious sign that someone is pregnant is a missed period. There are, however, other indicators of pregnancy, many of which can also be symptoms of premenstrual syndrome (PMS), which occurs before a period. The most reliable way to be sure is to take a pregnancy test.



◁ Missed period

If a person is sexually active and misses their period, it could be a sign of pregnancy. This may not be a reliable indicator for teens, however, as they often have irregular periods.

TEEN HINTS

If your partner is pregnant

Despite not carrying the baby, you and your girlfriend are both involved in the pregnancy. It's important that you're there to support your partner. You can help with any joint decisions that need to be made. It's usually also best to tell your parents, so that they can offer help and support.



△ Morning sickness

Nausea and/or vomiting can actually occur at any time of the day, not just in the morning.



△ Fatigue

Being pregnant might make some people feel unusually tired and lacking in energy or concentration.